



1. We have no choice about past facts.
2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.
3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X, we have no choice about X.
5. God knowing that we will perform some action necessitates that we will perform that action.

C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions. (3,4,5)

THE FOREKNOLEDGE ARGUMENT

1. We have no choice about past facts.
 - 2*. In the past, there were truths about all of our future actions.
 3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
 4. If we have no choice about p, and no choice about the fact that if p, then q, then we have no choice about q.
 - 5*. We have no choice about the fact that if it is true that I will perform some action, then I will perform that action.
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C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions.
(3,4,5)

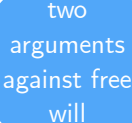
The fatalist argument

Now that we have this

improved in one respect.

argument on the table,

notice that it can be



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

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THE FOREKNOWLEDGE ARGUMENT



God knows that in the fire I will

and those facts need sit at X , we have

5. God knowing that we will perform some

perform certain action. (1,2)

in inches.

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of

ovivivivaatidis.

1. We have no choice about past facts.

perform future actions. (3,4,5)

action necessitates that we will perform

the artist in action.



3. We have not checked whether

4. If we have not shown facts,

C. We have no choice about whether we will





5* We have established the fact

performa certain action (1,2)

then we have the choice about q.

3 We have not heard that

Goodbye to that little girl

1. **Introduction**

2. **Background**

3. **Methodology**

4. **Results**

5. **Discussion**

6. **Conclusion**

7. **References**

8. **Appendix**

all of our activities.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

acai.oi.

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

that if it is true that I will perform

(3, 4, 5)

2* In the past, there were trials about

some action, then I will perform that

will perform various actions.

1. We have no advice about past facts.

0. We have introduced what we

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predictor.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

things as fate, then there is no free will.

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

We'll shortly consider some ways of

responding to Edwards' argument. But

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

first let's think about how Edwards'

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

there were truths about all our future

Suppose that someone did not believe in

similar to Edwards' argument?

actions. Could they give an argument

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

with reference to the being of truth about

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

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The fatalist argument